

Session Note - March 14, 2026

Patient: David Thompson

Therapist: Dr. Lisa Chang, LMHC

Presenting Concerns:

Patient presents with alcohol use disorder, moderate severity. Reports drinking 4-6 beers daily for the past two years, with recent increase following marital stress. Secondary concerns include relationship difficulties and occupational impairment. Concerns are ongoing. Triggers include arguments with spouse and work pressure.

Session Summary:

In-person session using motivational interviewing techniques. Explored ambivalence about reducing alcohol use. Patient identified discrepancy between current drinking patterns and desire to be a good father. Completed decisional balance exercise. Patient expressed readiness to reduce intake but not abstain completely at this time.

Mood Assessment:

Current mood: 4/10 (stressed and conflicted)

Mood change from last session: Stable

Energy level: Low

Emotional themes: guilt, conflict, determination

Affect observed: Anxious

Affect congruence: Congruent

Mood variability: Variable

Mental Status Examination:

Appearance: Appropriate

Behavior: Cooperative, intermittent eye contact

Speech: Normal

Thought process: Linear, some tangential remarks about marriage

Thought content: Preoccupied with relationship and drinking

Perception: No abnormalities

Cognition: Intact

Insight: Fair - recognizes problem but minimizes impact

Judgment: Fair

Risk Assessment:

Suicidal ideation: None. Self-harm: None. Homicidal ideation: None. Risk level: Low.

Interventions Used:

- Motivational interviewing
- Psychoeducation about alcohol effects
- Harm reduction planning

Techniques somewhat effective - patient engaged in discussion but ambivalent about change.

Skills taught: Drink tracking, identifying high-risk situations

Homework assigned: Track daily alcohol intake and note triggers for each drinking episode

Previous homework: Not completed - patient forgot to bring tracking sheet

Medications discussed: Discussed naltrexone as option. Patient interested but wants to discuss with primary care provider first. Currently on no psychotropic medications.

Medication adherence: Not applicable

Diagnoses:

Primary diagnosis: Alcohol Use Disorder, moderate

Primary diagnosis code: F10.20

Diagnosis status: No change

Secondary concerns noted: Marital distress

Treatment Progress:

Overall progress: Stable - maintaining engagement but limited behavior change

Treatment phase: Early

Barriers: Ambivalence about change, enabling social environment, marital stress

Strengths: Desire to be a good parent, attending sessions consistently

Treatment goals: Reduce alcohol use to safe levels, improve marital communication, develop healthy coping strategies

Goals addressed: Exploring motivation for change

Plan:

- Continue weekly sessions
- Next session: March 21, 2026
- Focus: Review drink tracking and develop harm reduction plan
- Referral to IOP program discussed - patient considering but not ready
- Coordination with PCP Dr. Miller needed for naltrexone evaluation
- Level of care recommendation: Consider IOP if outpatient insufficient
- Discharge planning: Not planned